Secure & Automated IT Operations Workflow

Executive Summary & Project Proposal | 4-week implementation | October 2026 | v1.1

1. Executive Summary

IT support and security work currently depends on individual habits: tasks are tracked informally, documentation is incomplete and security checks are performed irregularly. This proposal sets out a 4-week plan to bring newly onboarded team members into a single, structured way of working: a shared task board and ticket workflow, a security baseline for Linux (Ubuntu/Kali) and Windows, a clear escalation path, and a Python/SQL log-monitoring proof of concept that turns raw authentication logs into a daily prioritised report. The outcome is faster, more predictable support, earlier detection of suspicious activity and a team that knows who does what and when to escalate.

2. Project Scope & Objectives

Area	Objective	Target by end of Week 4
Operational goals	Standardise daily operations: Kanban task board, ticket categories/priorities with SLAs, runbook template, 15-min daily sync	100% of work items on the board; all team members using ticket IDs; runbooks for top 10 recurring issues
Security enhancement	Publish baseline policy and hardening checklists (access control, patching, logging, MFA); run audit on in-scope hosts	Baseline compliance ≥ 90% (in-scope hosts passing all Critical/High controls); zero unapproved admin accounts; awareness training delivered
Workflow improvement	Escalation matrix for tickets (L1-L3) and security incidents (SEV-1 to SEV-4) with owners and time limits	Tabletop incident exercise completed; escalation process used for all P1/P2 and security tickets
Automation	Log-parsing and access-validation script with SQL summaries, scheduled daily with cron on Linux hosts	Daily report on 2 Linux pilot hosts, then all in-scope Linux hosts; findings mapped to severity. Windows parsing is Phase 2

In scope: process design, documentation, baseline policies, training, PoC automation. **Out of scope:** purchase of a full SIEM, network redesign, unapproved production changes, automated Windows log parsing (Windows hosts are covered by the checklist audit and manual Event Viewer review; Phase 2).

3. Implementation Timeline

Week	Focus	Key deliverables / milestone
1	Discovery & foundations	Asset inventory, task board, documentation standard, risk register (M1)
2	Security baseline & process design	Linux/Windows baseline, escalation matrix, awareness guide, sponsor approval (M2)
3	Implementation & automation	Baseline phishing simulation (Day 11), pilot audit (2 Linux + 2 Windows), log script live on Linux pilots, access review, training (M3)
4	Rollout, measurement, handover	Extend to all hosts, tabletop exercise, follow-up phishing simulation, KPI report, retrospective, handover (M4)

4. Team Coordination & Leadership Approach

- **Delegation:** one named owner per task, WIP limit of 3, buddy pairing for new members, peer review as definition of done.
- **Daily sync (15 min):** yesterday / today / blockers / security watch from the daily log report; async update for absentees.
- **Escalation:** L0 owner (2 h) → L1 project lead (same day) → L2 IT operations manager (1 day); security incidents go directly to the security lead and sponsor.
- **Culture:** blameless retrospectives, single source of truth (board + wiki), reporting suspected incidents is always encouraged.

5. Risk Management & Compliance

Risk	Likelihood / Impact	Mitigation	Owner
Operational bottleneck: knowledge held by one person; ticket backlog	Med / High	Runbooks, buddy system, WIP limits, priority rules, cross-training	Project lead
Slow adoption of new workflow by the team	Med / Med	Short daily syncs, visible board, quick wins in Week 1, manager sponsorship	Project lead
Data security: excess privileges, shared or stale accounts	High / High	Least privilege, quarterly access review, script validates accounts against approved list	Security
Undetected brute-force or credential compromise	Med / High	Daily log analysis, fail2ban/lockout policy, MFA, SEV-2 escalation within 1 hour	Sysadmin
Log data contains personal data; script or reports leak it	Low / High	Read-only script run as non-root user, owner-only report folder (0700), 90-day retention, no secrets in tickets, GDPR check with DPO	Security
Windows hosts have no automated log review	High / Med	Manual Event Viewer review of IDs 4624/4625/4720/4732 in this project; Windows Event Log parsing in Phase 2	Sysadmin
Hardening changes break services	Med / Med	Pilot hosts first, change approval, backups and rollback plan	Sysadmin
Scope creep / schedule slip in a 4-week window	Med / Med	Fixed scope list, weekly review, backlog for phase 2	Project lead

Compliance: the baseline follows common good practice (least privilege, MFA, patching, logging, audit trail), aligned with the intent of CIS Benchmarks and ISO/IEC 27001 controls; personal-data incidents are handled under GDPR (72-hour authority notification where required). Exceptions need written approval with expiry date.

6. KPIs & Performance Metrics

Every KPI has a baseline captured in Week 1 (Day 3-5) from the stated source, a Week 4 target, and a review frequency. Compliance % = in-scope hosts passing all Critical/High baseline controls / all in-scope hosts (approved exceptions are not counted as passing). Targets are reviewed weekly (Friday), reported to the sponsor on Day 15 and Day 19, then monthly.

Category	KPI	Baseline (how captured)	Week 4 target	Review
Process efficiency	Mean time to resolve P3 tickets	Last 30 days, ticket export (Day 3-5)	-25% vs. baseline	Weekly
Process efficiency	SLA compliance (response / resolution)	Last 30 days, ticket export (Day 3-5)	≥ 90%	Weekly
Process efficiency	Escalations with complete handover info	Audit of 20 recent escalated tickets (Day 5)	≥ 95%	Weekly
Security	Baseline compliance (hosts passing)	Pilot audit Day 11-12, extended Day 16-17	≥ 90% (95% after Phase 2)	Weekly
Security	Unapproved and dormant (90 d) accounts	First access-validation run (Day 14)	0 unapproved; dormant < 2%	Weekly
Security	Time from SEV-2 detection to containment	Tabletop exercise, Day 18 (no earlier data)	≤ 1 hour	Per incident
Awareness adoption	Training attendance / quiz pass rate (80% pass mark)	0% before Day 15 session	100% / ≥ 90%	Once; quarterly
Awareness adoption	Phishing: report rate in simulation	Baseline simulation, Day 11	Report rate > 60%, click rate below baseline (Day 19)	Quarterly
Team productivity	Board tasks completed on time	Weeks 1-2 completion rate (Day 10)	≥ 85%	Weekly
Team productivity	Blockers resolved within 1 business day	Weeks 1-2 blocker log (Day 10)	≥ 80%	Weekly
Automation	In-scope Linux hosts with daily log report	0 hosts (Day 1)	100% of in-scope Linux hosts	Weekly

7. Deliverables & Next Steps

The accompanying package contains the roadmap and team coordination strategy, the security awareness guide and baseline policy, the troubleshooting and escalation matrix with process maps, and the working Python/SQL log-analysis script with README, tests and sample data, all under version control. **Decision requested:** approve the charter and pilot host list so Week 1 can begin; the sponsor receives a KPI report at the end of Week 4 with recommendations for phase 2 (Windows event-log parsing, central log collection/SIEM evaluation, automated alerting).